

DATA & AI COMMUNITY DAY DURBAN

PLUGGED IN» Canvassing Your Agents



THE COUNTDOWN



JOURNEY TO THE STAGE

100% of countdown
elapsed

11 Sept

19 Sept

8 of 8 days elapsed

EVERY DAY COUNTS



Saturday 19 September 2026



Richfield College, Umhlanga

FREE

Featuring **GitHub Copilot Dev Days 2026**



DEV DAYS 2026

Durban

SEPTEMBER 19



THANK YOU TO OUR SPONSORS

Platinum:



RICHFIELD



Gold:



Astel Systems

Silver:



Ind. Contributors:

Mohammed Farhaan Backas et al.

Lawrance Reddy



- **Twitter:** @adpead
- **About.me:** https://about.me/allan_pead
- **Linkedin:** <https://www.linkedin.com/in/adpead/>
- **Blog:** <https://explorationspace.co.za>
- **Raspberry Pi South Africa**
- <https://www.facebook.com/groups/1493503984198019>
- **Cape Town MS Developer User Group**
- <https://www.meetup.com/Cape-Town-Ms-Dev-User-Group/>



Microsoft Internet of Things Most Valuable Professional
Microsoft Developer Technologies Most Valuable Professional

Allan Pead



GitHub Copilot App

The desktop hub experience for agent-driven development, built natively on GitHub.



Delegate to agents

Start from an issue, prompt, or open PR.



Centralized inbox

Every session's progress in one place.



Shape canvases

Direct agents with structured context.



Review and merge

Inspect diffs and merge without leaving.



GitHub Canvas

A shared surface for humans and agents

Canvases are bidirectional: the agent updates the surface while it works, and you edit right alongside it.



Agentic kanban boards

Add cards, move work, kick off tasks.



Issue triage boards

Summarize themes and pain points.



Markdown canvases

One editable surface for your day.



Document canvases

Edit docs, sheets, and decks in-app.



GitHub Canvas

The model sees what you do on the canvas

The user just finished drawing a shape on the "Shape Guessing Game" canvas (instance "demo-1"). Call the `get_drawing` action on that canvas to inspect its geometric features, decide what shape it most likely is, then call the `set_guess` action on that same canvas with your guess. Keep your chat reply brief.

> `invoke_canvas_action`

I'm guessing **trapezoid** — closed, elongated (aspect ratio 2.34), ~4 corners, but circularity 0.61 (lower than a clean rectangle), suggesting an irregular quadrilateral.

The user just finished drawing a shape on the "Shape Guessing Game" canvas (instance "demo-1"). Call the `get_drawing` action on that canvas to inspect its geometric features, decide what shape it most likely is, then call the `set_guess` action on that same canvas with your guess. Keep your chat reply brief.

> `invoke_canvas_action`

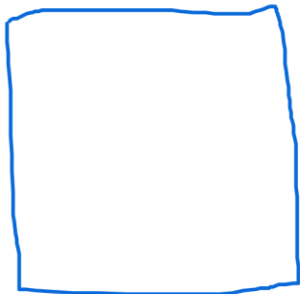
I'm guessing **square** — closed shape, ~4 corners, aspect ratio ~1.0, circularity 0.81 (very close to a square's ~0.785).

Ask anything. Use / for commands, & sessions, @ files...

+ Interactive Auto · Balance

Shape Guessing Game

Draw a shape, then click "Guess my shape!" and let the model figure out what it is.



Clear Undo stroke **Guess my shape!**

● I think it's a square! (80% confident)



GitHub Canvas – Creating an Issue Tracker

GitHub Copilot

Issues dash... Commit (2) apead/DevDa x +

Copilot session started

`create-canvas` create an issue tracking dashboard to manage application development and manage defects and enhancements use Github's Issues system

Thought for 6s

I'll build this as a GitHub Issues-backed canvas; first I'm loading the canonical extension SDK guidance before choosing its install scope.

> Read \\?C:\Users\apead\AppData\Local\Programs\...

I'll install it at project scope so the dashboard is versioned with the repository and available to the team. Next I'm s the repository's GitHub data.

> Inspect repos

The repository a enhancement is I'm wiring a theme

Changes +825

Ask anything. Use / for commands, @ files, & sessions, # issues...

Issues dashboard

apead/DevDaysMauiLunchApp

Open work 15	Open defects 10
Open enhancements 5	Closed 0

Search issues...

All work types

Open

Recently updated

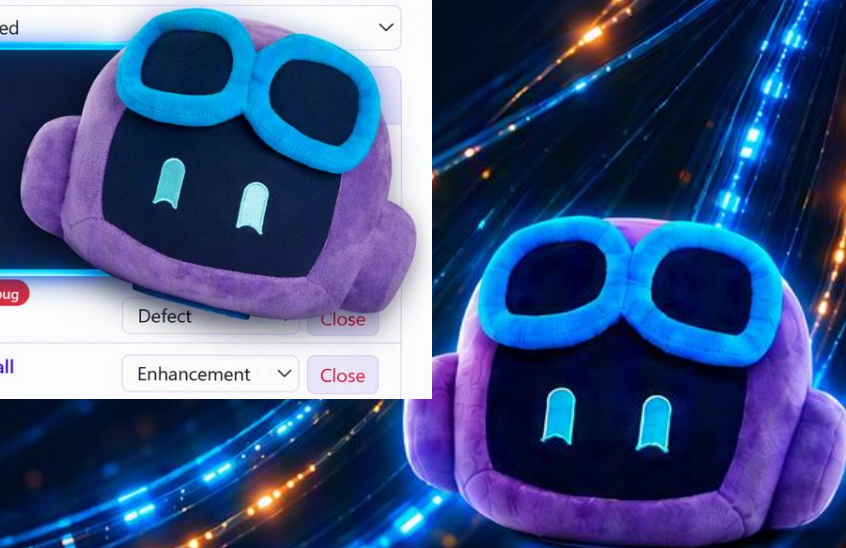
`/create-canvas` create an issue tracking dashboard to manage application development and manage defects and enhancements use Github's Issues system

#13 [Fictional Bug] VoiceOver reads spice emoji as repeated generic symbols **bug**
open opened by @apead · updated 9/18/2026, 9:54:27 PM

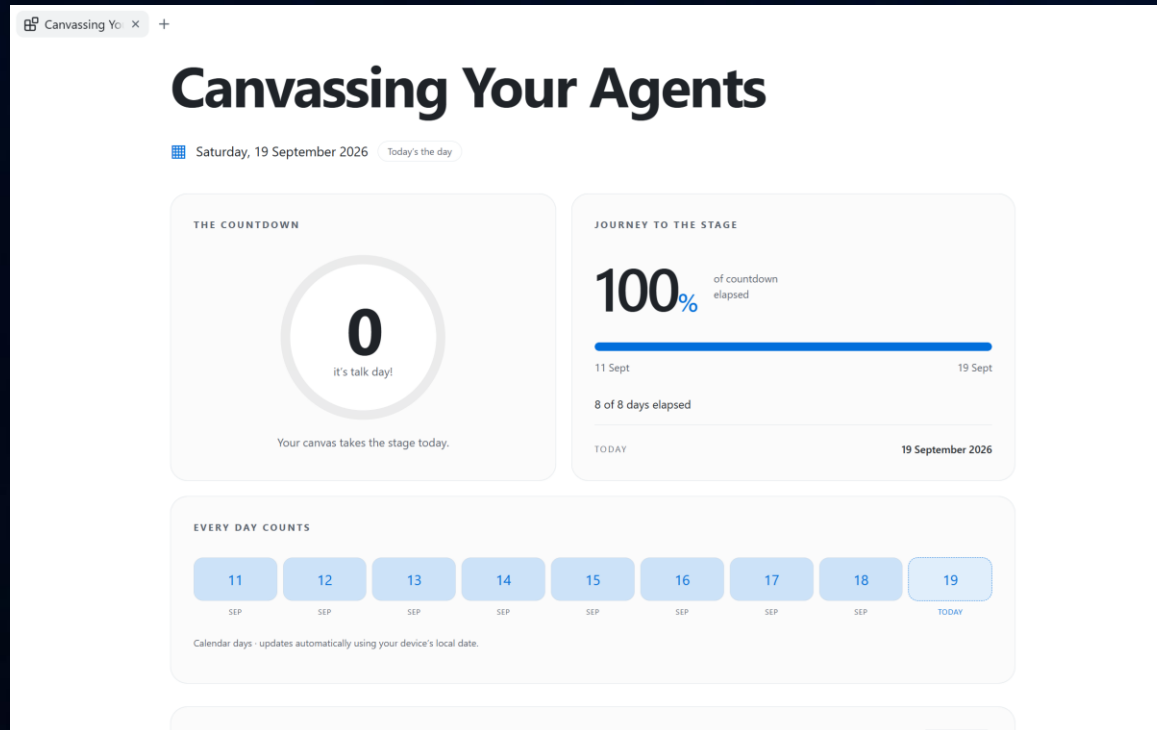
#12 [Fictional Feature] Support scheduled pickup slots for the DevDays lunch hall **enhancement**

Defect Close

Enhancement Close

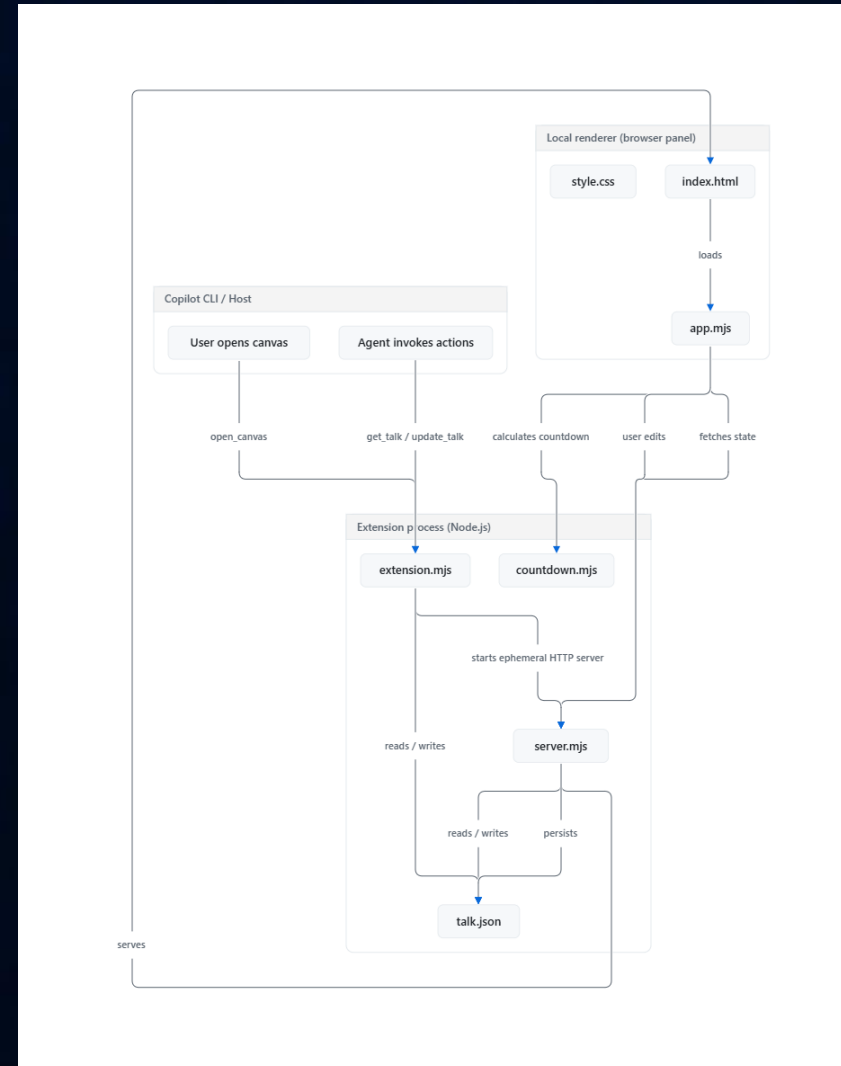


Inside the Canvas Extension



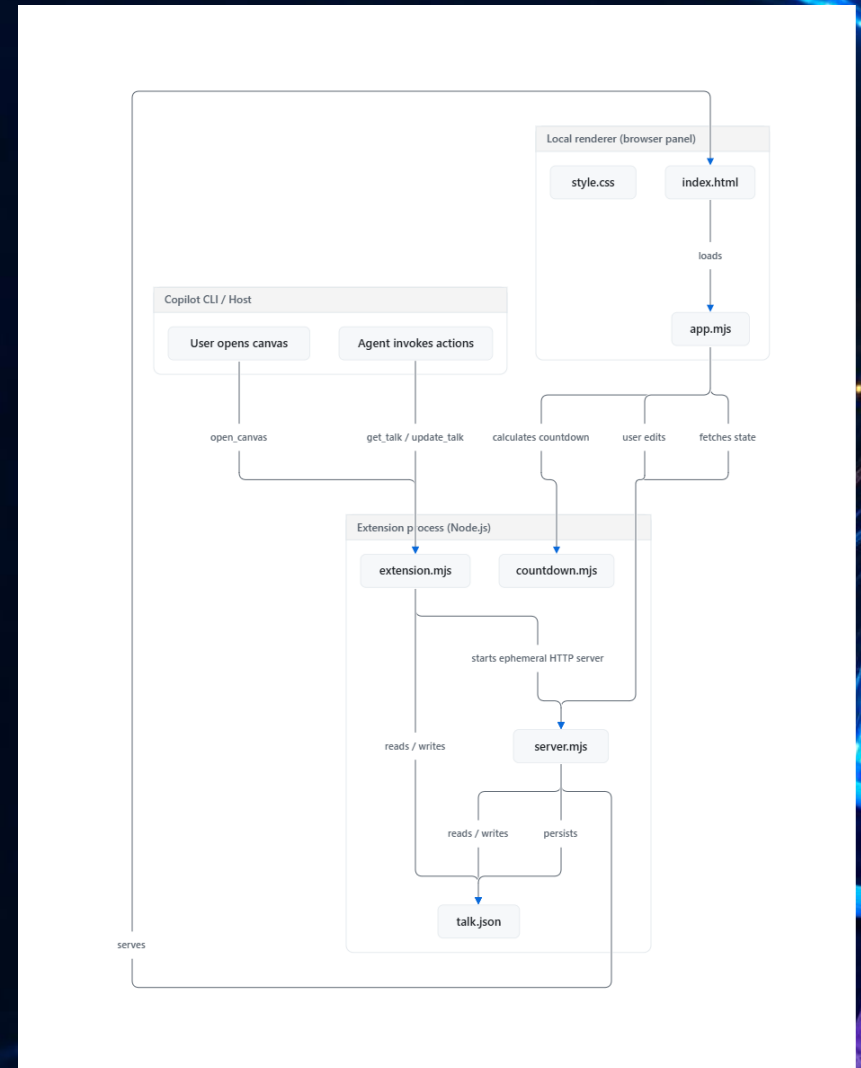
Inside the Canvas Extension

extension.mjs	Joins the Copilot session, declares the canvas, and wires open / close / action handlers.
server.mjs	Starts a local HTTP server on an ephemeral port, serves static assets, and exposes a /state endpoint for reading and saving the talk.
talk.json	The single source of truth: title, description, start date, event date, and revision.
countdown.mjs	Pure date math: computes elapsed days, remaining days, progress percentage, and phase.
index.html	The canvas UI shell.
app.mjs	Fetches state, renders gauges and timeline, handles editing, and polls for updates.
style.css	Visual styling for gauges, timeline, and responsive layout.



Inside the Canvas Extension – Life Cycle

Discovery	Copilot CLI scans .github/extensions/talk-countdown/ and finds extension.mjs.
Launch	The CLI forks the extension as a child process.
Join session	extension.mjs calls joinSession() and registers the canvas plus two actions: get_talk and update_talk.
Open canvas	When the user (or agent) calls open_canvas, the extension starts a local HTTP server and returns its URL to the host.
Render	The host loads the URL in a side panel. The browser fetches index.html, app.mjs, style.css, and countdown.mjs from the local server.
Shared state	app.mjs calls GET /state to load talk.json, then renders the countdown. Edits are sent back via POST /state.
Agent actions	The agent can also read or update the same talk.json through get_talk and update_talk.
Close	When the canvas closes, the extension shuts down the local HTTP server.



Built in Commands

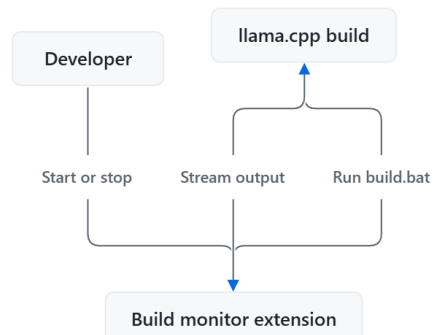
Build & Discover	Run & Manage
/create-canvas — scaffold a new canvas	open_canvas — launch a panel
extensions_manage — scaffold / list / inspect	invoke_canvas_action — trigger a behavior
install_extension — bring one in	list_canvas_capabilities — see what it can do
share_extension — publish one out	discover_widgets / render_widget / clear_widget — UI output



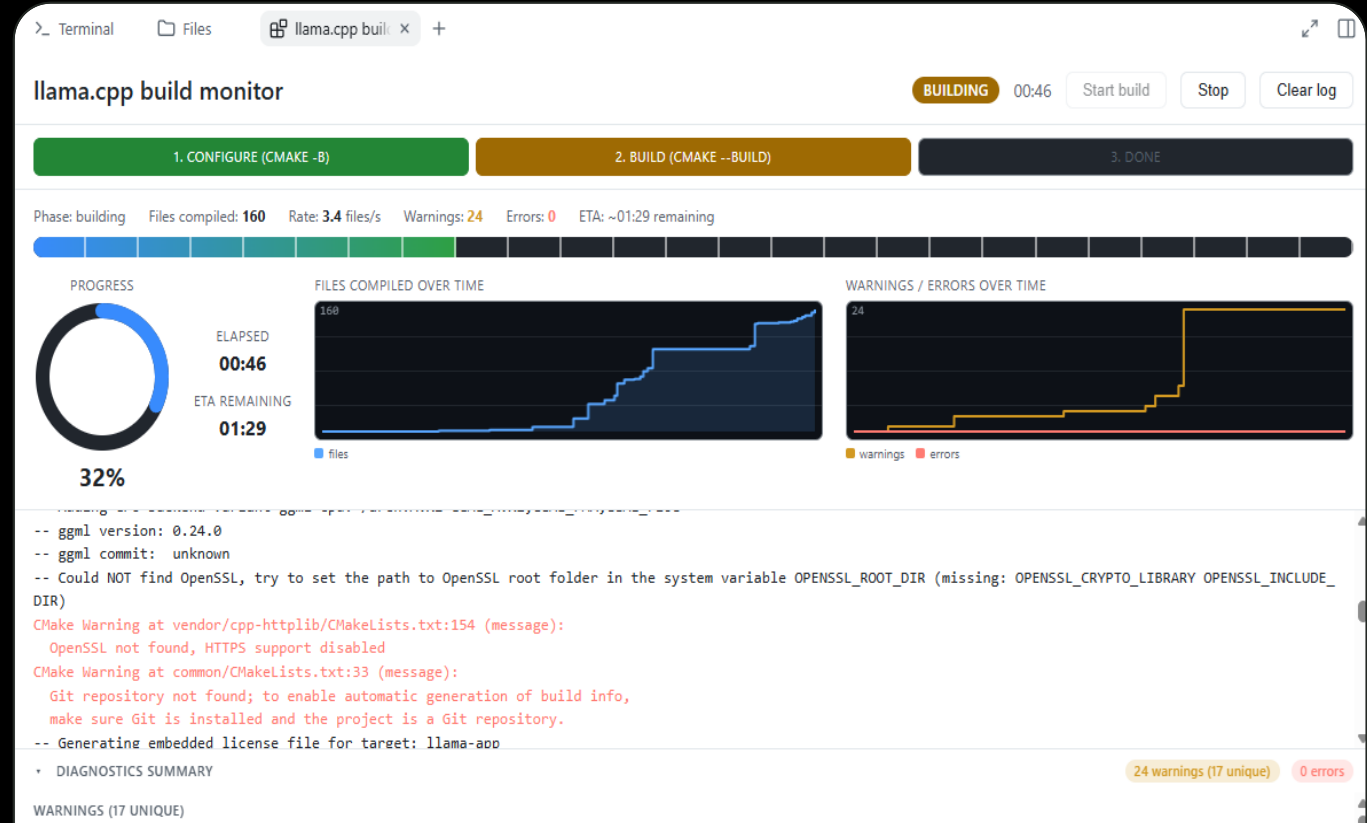
Example Use Cases - Long Running Process Dashboards



Long Running Process Dashboards

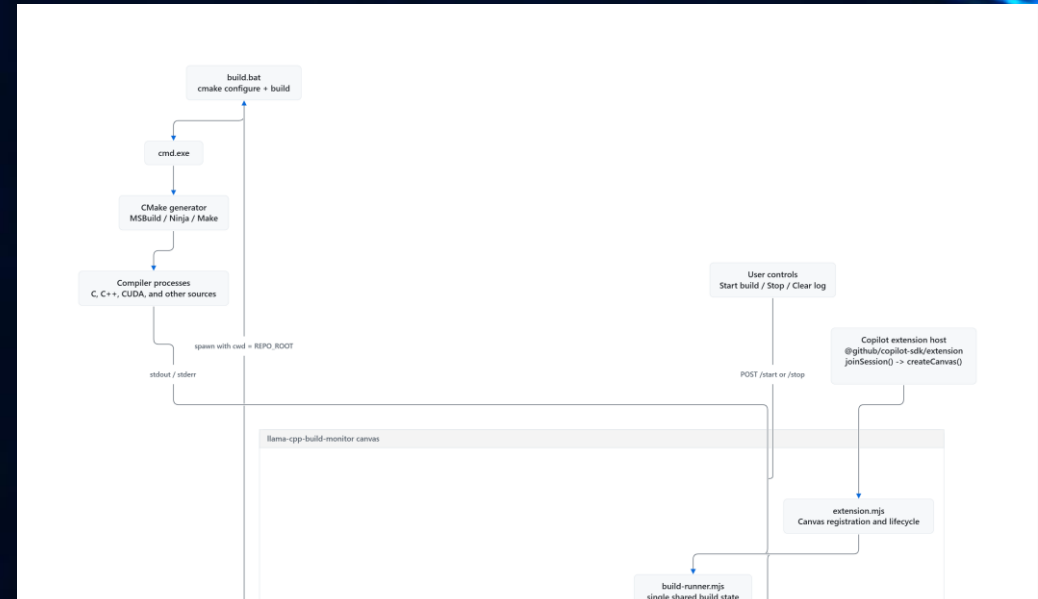
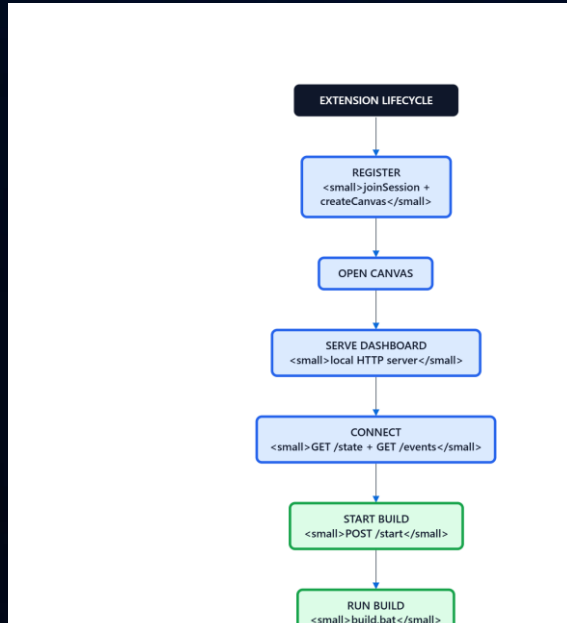


```
@echo off
where cl >nul 2>nul
if %errorlevel% == 0 (
    cmake -B build
) else (
    cmake -B build -G "MinGW Makefiles" -DCMAKE_C_FLAGS="-D_WIN32_WINNT=0x0A00" -DCMAKE_CXX_FLAGS="-D_WIN32_WINNT=0x0A00"
)
cmake --build build --config Release
```



Runs build.bat (cmake -B build && cmake --build build --config Release) in the workspace root.

Long Running Process Dashboards



`/create-canvas` create a full monitoring dashboard with gauges and graphs with the output of `build.bat` I would like to have graphics progress of the build |



Example Use Cases - MAUI Dev Flow Inspector

Tapped the cart pill's inner border (the actual tap target) to view the cart.

how many items in the cart?

> Check the current screen contents (cart page) and 2 other tool calls

The cart pill shows 1 item in the cart (the cart bar at the bottom also confirms: 1 item, "View cart", total R 95.00). Still on the menu page — the cart pill tap didn't navigate to a full cart screen, just kept the cart bar visible at the bottom.

restart the canvas extension

🔧 Extensions reload

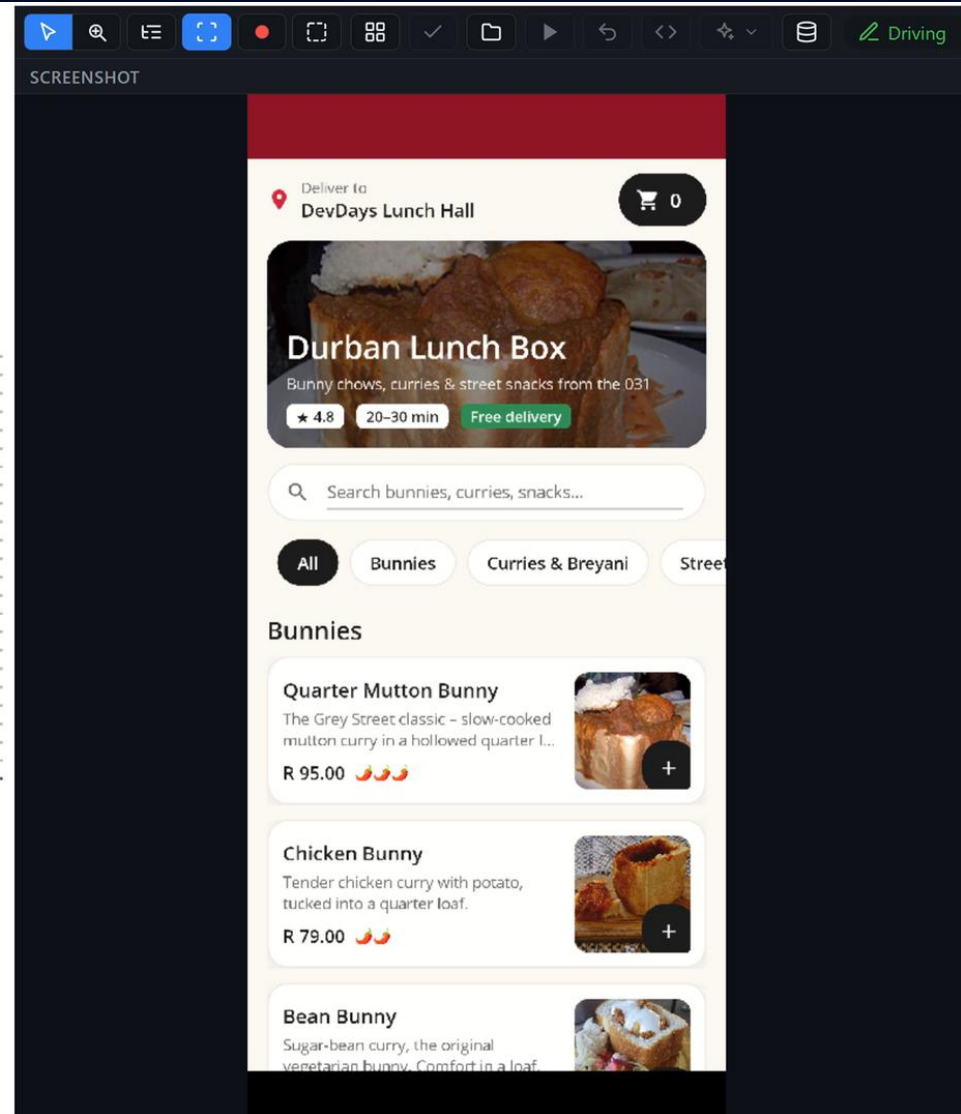
Extension reloaded successfully.

> Get current agent port and 3 other tool calls

Canvas extension restarted and reconnected to DevDays Lunch on the new port 10245 .

Ask anything. Use **I** for commands, @ files, & sessions, # issues...

+ Interactive Auto · Balance Default agent



Awesome Copilot Extensions

36 canvases, one command away

Community-built extensions for the Copilot app: kanban boards, dashboards, notebooks, even a few games.



Notebook

Run and checkpoint Jupyter notebooks live.



Diagram Explorer

Click nodes, drill into explanations.



Issues Kanban

Plan and track remediation work.



Token Pac-Man

AI-credit usage as a playable board.

<https://awesome-copilot.github.com/extensions/>



Example Use Cases - Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge 4 - Remaster

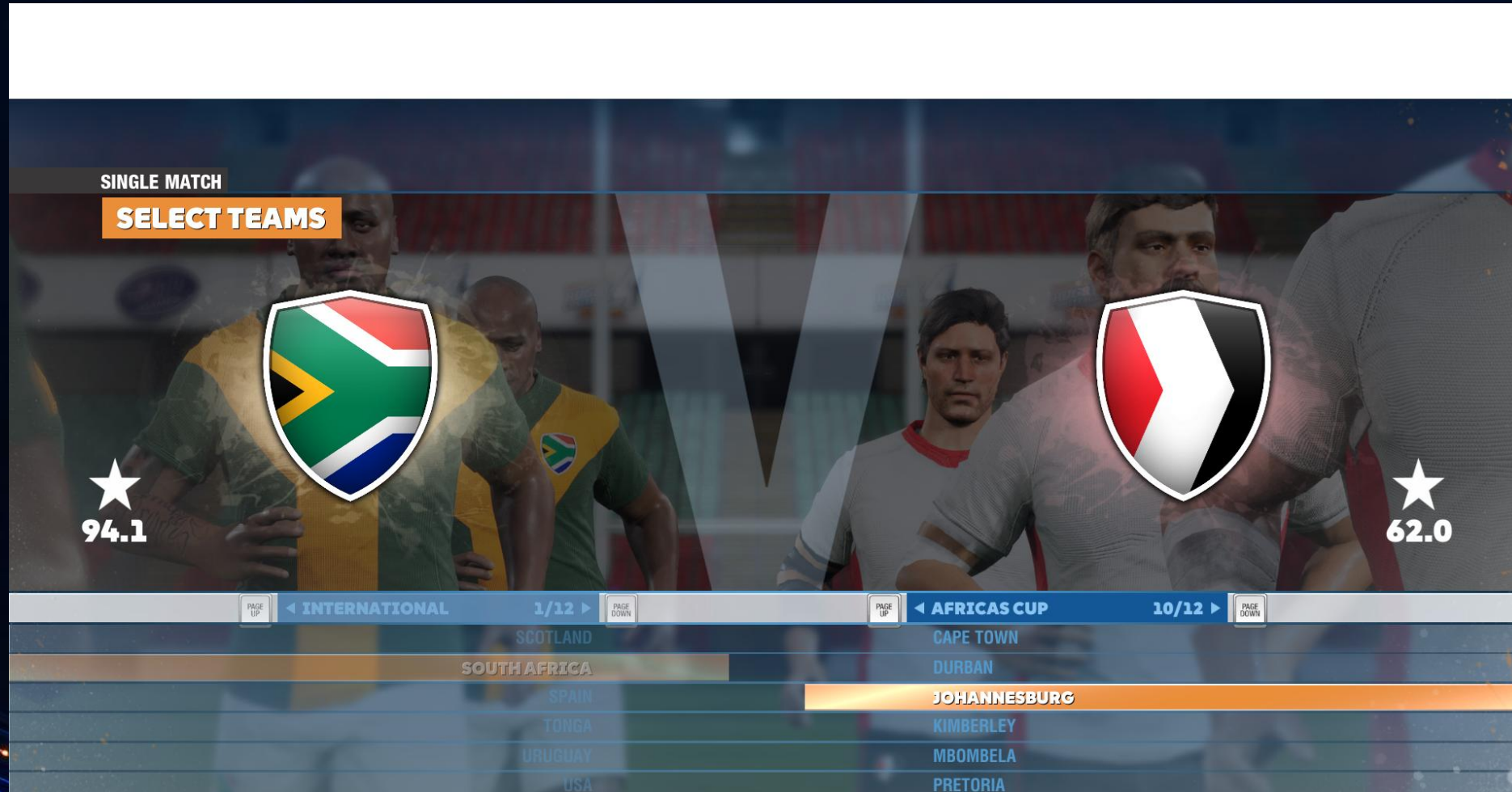


Release in honour of Jonah Lomu on Steam 💖

All the commercial and sponsor licenses expired!



Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge 4 – Remaster (OOB)



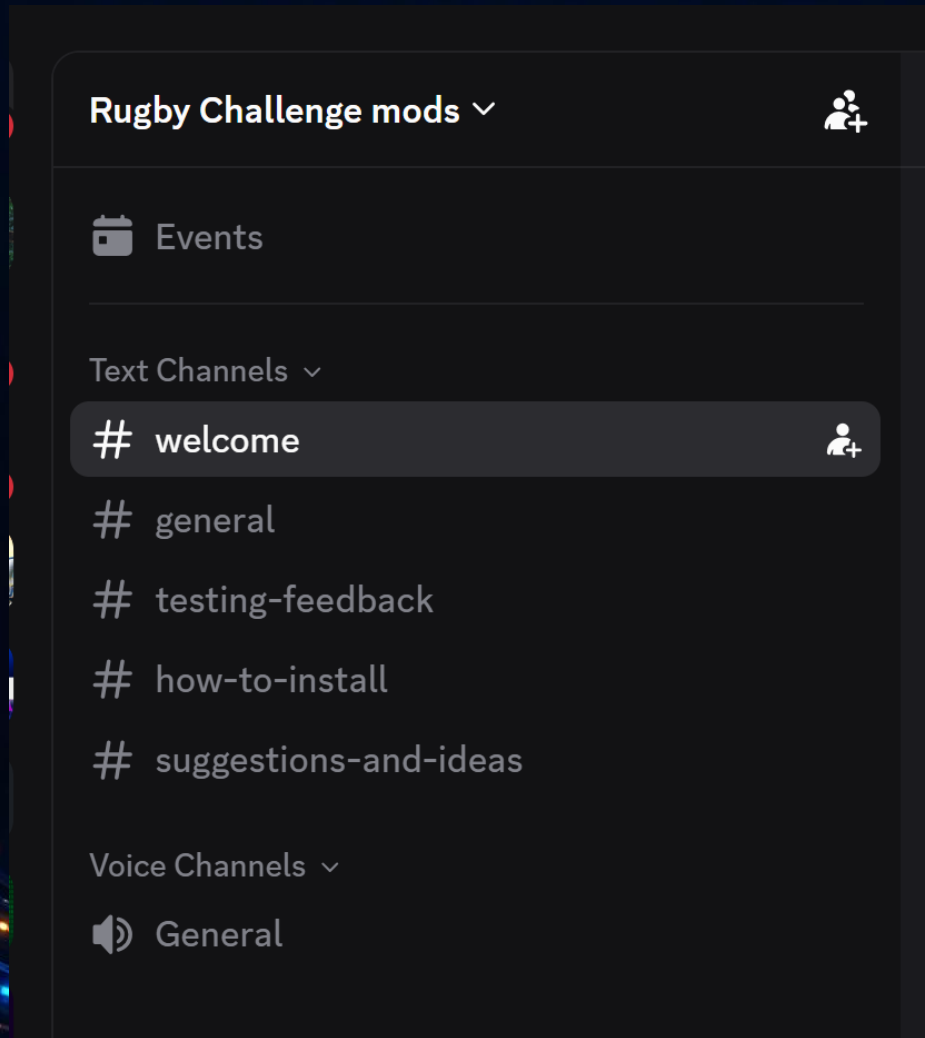
Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge 4 - Remaster (OOB)



Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge 4 – Remaster (OOB)



Rugby Community Modders



*It's impossible – use
the older Rugby games
instead*



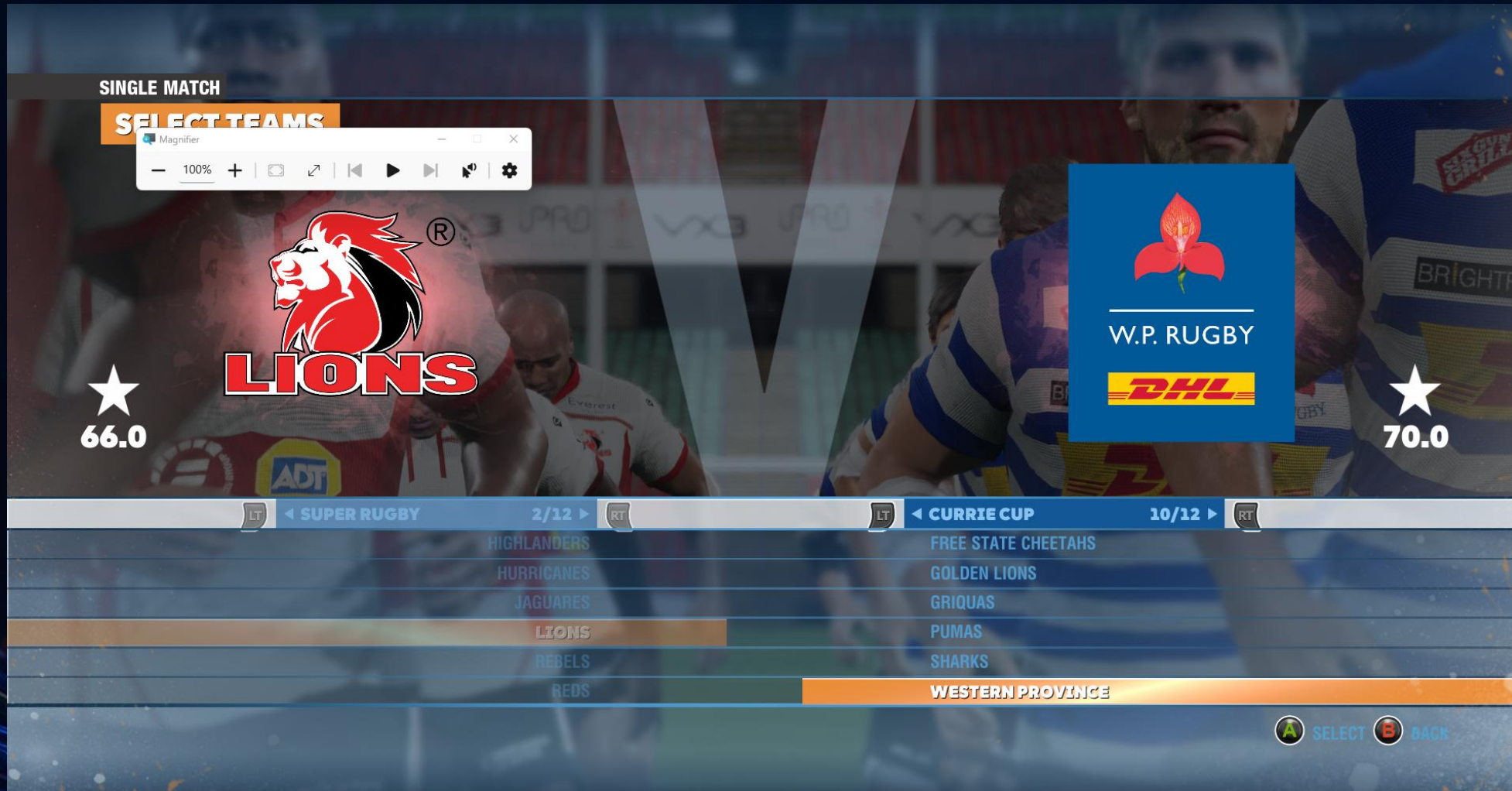
Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge 4 – Remaster (CM)



Images from GitHub Copilot Assisted Community created mod



Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge 4 – Remaster (CM)



Images from GitHub Copilot Assisted Community created mod

Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge 4 – Remaster (CM)



Images from GitHub Copilot Assisted Community created mod



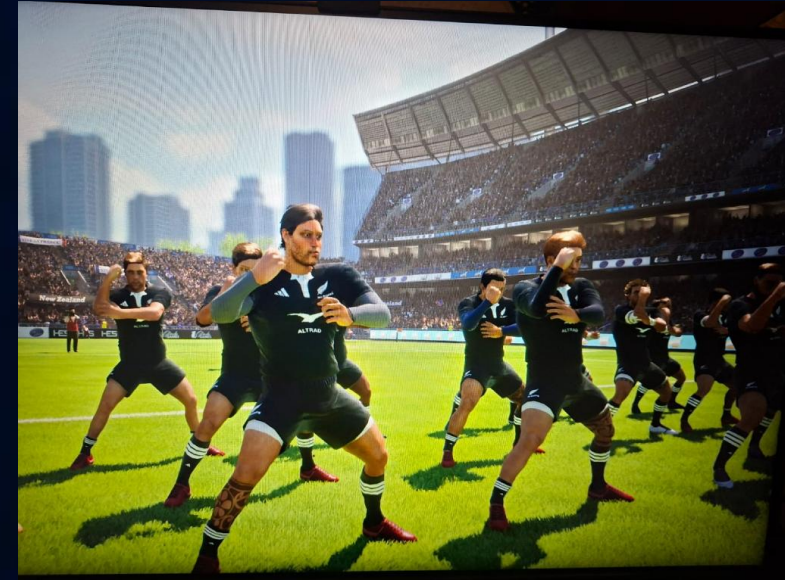
Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge 4 – Remaster (CM)



Images from GitHub Copilot Assisted Community created mod



Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge 4 – Remaster (CM)



The modding challenge

Kit textures (player/texture/clothes)	1,759
Stadium world textures (world/*)	1,476
Player heads/skin/hair/tattoos	720
Team + competition logos (ui/logos)	617
Number decals (player/texture/number)	340
Stadium signage (prop/signage)	185
Goal posts (prop/goal_post)	60
Boots (player/texture/shoe)	40
Balls (prop/ball)	29
Field decals (prop/field)	1

Database teams	173 teams
Database players	5,426 players
Database lineups	181 lineups
Team→kit mapping	143 kit codes
Commentary (play-by-play)	26,320
Commentary (colour samples)	1,950
Transition videos	147 MB



The modding challenge - Textures

Rugby/Content/Rugby/cmn_con/ (the game's own art)	13,466
— player/	5,455
— world/ (10 stadiums + training field)	4,202
— UI/	1,797
— prop/	1,630
— effects / HUD / audio / grass / misc	382
Rugby/Content/ other (cutscenes, UI widgets, FMOD, UltraDynamicSky, DataTables, per-platform)	3,303
Rugby/Plugins/ (wwStadiumTool etc.)	1,034
Engine/	451



- Two way visual Automation tool

Asset Generation

- AI
- Community Humans

Roster Creation

Legacy Mod conversions

RC 3 – Custom Wicked Witch

RC 4 – Unreal Engine 4

RC4 MOD INSPECTOR

DASHBOARD INSTANCE RC4-INSPECTOR-1 · READ-ONLY REPOSITORY INSPECTION

REFRESH

REMASTERED BASE

PACKAGES	18,220
TEXTURES	8,471
COMMENTARY	26,320 samples
BASE IOSTORE	7.94 GB

PLAYTEST BUNDLE

0.0 MB across 1 files in this checkout

Nine containers plus 1.07 GB of audio. The dashboard never deploys, rebuilds, or edits game files.

MOD COVERAGE

AREA	REPLACED / TOTAL	COVERAGE
Textures	1,627 / 8,471	19%
Kit teams	127 / 289	44%
Logos	610 / 619	98.5%
Balls	27 / 27	100%
Commentary clips	163 / 26,320	0.6%

CONTAINERS

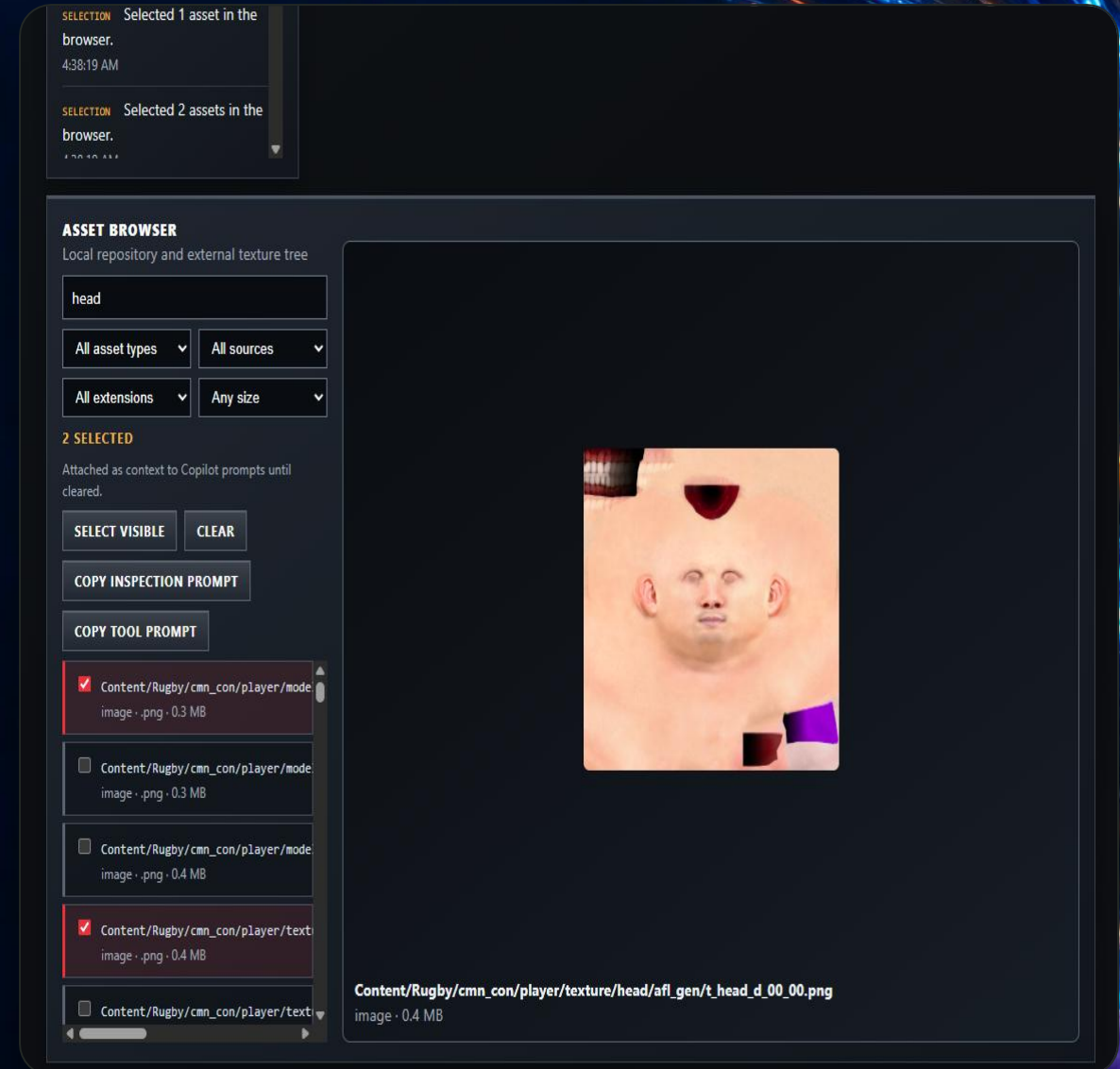
CONTAINER	ASSETS	SIZE
KitsFullMod	803	2.36 GB
LogosMod	575	273 MB
PropsMod	148	261 MB
TransitionsMod	35	147 MB
FieldDecalsMod	45	126 MB

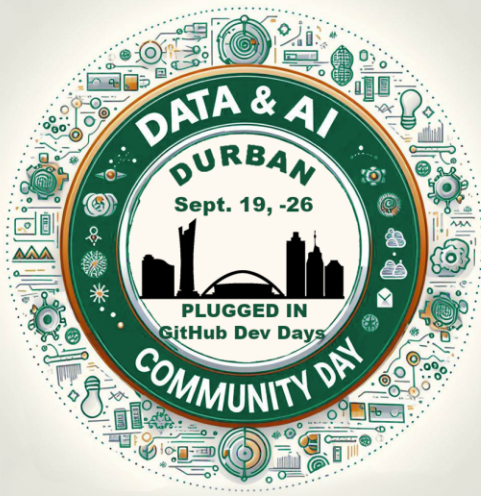
Asset Visualization

Feedback into prompts

Bulk Intelligent Updates of Assets

Bulk Intelligent Data Updates





DON'T FORGET SESSION EVALUATION

- Please evaluate the session!
 - Enter your name on the evaluation form to stand a chance to win awesome prizes!
- Eval app:
 - Scan the code
 - Android:
 - Click on the hamburger menu on the top.
 - Choose "Add to Home screen", and it is installed.
 - iPhone:
 - Click on the hamburger menu on the bottom.
 - Choose "Add to favorites".
 - URL:
 - <https://forms.cloud.microsoft/r/4LwsKwVxaB>



PLUGGED IN >>

- **Twitter:** @adpead
- **About.me:** https://about.me/allan_pead
- **Linkedin:** <https://www.linkedin.com/in/adpead/>
- **Blog:** <https://explorationspace.co.za>
- **Raspberry Pi South Africa**
- <https://www.facebook.com/groups/1493503984198019>



Thank you!!

Canvassing Your Agents

Resources

Awesome Copilot Extensions

<https://awesome-copilot.github.com/extensions/>

GitHub Copilot Canvases

<https://docs.github.com/en/copilot/how-tos/github-copilot-app/working-with-canvas-extensions>

MAUI DevFlow

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/dotnet/maui/developer-tools/devflow/?view=net-maui-10.0>

Jonah Lomu Rugby Challenge Mod

<https://discord.gg/BMfFa2TPK>

